

SIGNATURE TALENT

Victor Crane, Bear Raider

EXECUTIVE



HIRE
◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Financials funding source.

Whenever a Reputation, Corporate, or Regulation Stress Test resolves, gain 2 Surplus.

Commit this employee to look at the top card of an opponent's deck.

Has read your footnotes more closely than your auditors, and has already called the press.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 224 / 386

OFFICE LOCATION

Fully Remote

OFFICE LOCATION



EXCLUSIVE

▲ Cyber

Exclusive: Headquarters only; no other offices.

At the start of your turn, if you control an employee other than your CEO, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).

The first employee you hire on your turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

The headquarters is wherever the charger is.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 367 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN
● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN
● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN
● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN
● 0 run start

STAPLE

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN
● 0 run start

STAPLE

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NO. 036 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



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MARGIN
● 0 run start

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NO. 036 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN
● 0 run start

STAPLE

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Private Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1½

each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Private Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1½

each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Private Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1½

each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 386

INVESTMENT

Equity - Value

INVESTMENT

COST

2

YIELD

1

each turn

SALE

1

any time

▲ Long-Term Equity ▼ Inflation

Yield +1 while your company has no unhedged Long-Term Equity exposure.

Safe, stable, and boring.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 049 / 386

INVESTMENT

Litigation Finance

ILLIQUID

COST

2

YIELD

1

each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation ▼ Litigation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Whenever a Litigation Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

When claims severity rises, someone funds the lawsuit.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 066 / 386

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Sports-Gambling Prediction Markets

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

SIGNATURE

▲ **Regulation**

Signature: one copy per deck.

Whenever a Regulation, Market, or Geopolitical Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

Even the local pub needs to hedge sometimes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 076 / 386

INVESTMENT

INVESTMENT

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT

COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

▲ **Rising Interest Rates** ▼ **Short-Term Equity**

Yield +1 while your company has no unhedged Rising Interest Rates exposure.

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 053 / 386

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Short Sale

RESPONSE

COST
◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Play only against a Market Stress Test. Gain 3 Surplus.

Schadenfreude: German for enjoying someone else's portfolio falling.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 128 / 386

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Put Option

RESPONSE

COST
◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent all loss to you from this Stress Test's Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, and Volatility clauses.

Nobody puts equity in the corner.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 127 / 386

TALENT

TALENT

Research Analyst

FRONT LINE

HIRE
◆ 4

Requires a Financials funding source.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

The first time each round you discard an investment from your hand while this is in play, gain 2 Surplus.

Publishes forty pages a day, of which occasionally one is right.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 229 / 386

SURPRISE INSPECTION

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Short-Seller Report

REPUTATION

COST	HITS
◆ 4	Target opponent

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per investment they control and 1 per Dark card on their board, plus 4 more.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Blockchain Co. it controls.

Ninety-four pages, a catchy name, and a very bad morning for investor relations.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 285 / 386

SURPRISE INSPECTION

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Short and Distort

REPUTATION

COST	HITS
◆ 4	Target opponent

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per investment they control, plus 6 more.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Blockchain Co. it controls.

Step one: short the stock. Step two: post the rumor. There is no step three.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 302 / 386

SURPRISE INSPECTION

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Smear Campaign

REPUTATION

COST	HITS
◆ 4	Each opponent

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Each opponent loses 3 Surplus. Then they can't add a funding source on their next turn.

Sources close to no one say your rivals are in trouble.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 303 / 386

SURPRISE INSPECTION

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Whistleblower

CORPORATE

COST	HITS
◆ 3	Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 304 / 386

INVESTMENT

Trading Desk

INVESTMENT

COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Buys low, sells high, and has a very good explanation for the other days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 082 / 386

INVESTMENT

Trading Desk

INVESTMENT

COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Buys low, sells high, and has a very good explanation for the other days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 082 / 386

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Everything Is Securities Fraud

RESPONSE

COST

◆ 3

SIGNATURE RESPONSE

Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

When this Stress Test ends, target opponent loses as much Surplus again as Stress Tests have cost them this round.

The hurricane was nobody's fault, but the stock drop, says the complaint, was the CFO's.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 154 / 386

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Viral Solvency Rumor

REPUTATION

COST

◆ 7

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per funding source they control. Then they discard half their Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

The stock fell 40 percent on no news, which turned out to be the news.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 318 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Evergreen Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

▲ Credit

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Liquid in the brochure, quarterly in the prospectus, gated in the headline.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 040 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Evergreen Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

▲ Credit

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Liquid in the brochure, quarterly in the prospectus, gated in the headline.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 040 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Evergreen Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

▲ Credit

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Liquid in the brochure, quarterly in the prospectus, gated in the headline.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 040 / 386

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Noncompete Injunction

LITIGATION

COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

The judge agreed that the agreement was enforceable, and that the new job started in eighteen months.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 343 / 386

TOOL

Risk Analytics Desk

DATA

PRICE

◆ 1

Once each turn, after you play a treaty or cover, your next investment this turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

A smaller downside leaves room for the next idea.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 383 / 386

Risk Analytics Desk

DATA



PRICE

◆ 1

Once each turn, after you play a treaty or cover, your next investment this turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

A smaller downside leaves room for the next idea.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 383 / 386

Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: or draw on your turn.

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: or draw on your turn.

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

Scenario Rehearsal

ACTION - YOUR TURN



COST

◆ 2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

On your turn, privately look at the next 2 shared pile cards. Return them in either order, then discard this. Developing and delayed Stress Tests still happen first.

The disasters are still coming. The order is negotiable.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 175 / 386

Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

Save the company. Give up part of the business.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

Save the company. Give up part of the business.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

AI Bubble Bursts

MARKET



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every AI card and every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

It was three laptops in a trench coat the whole time.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 271 / 386

Dash for Cash

LIQUIDITY - AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 3 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 3 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

In March 2020, investors sold almost everything, even U.S. Treasuries, to raise cash, until the Federal Reserve stepped in.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 386

Flash Crash

MARKET - AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 290 / 386

Off-Channel Communications Sweep

REGULATION - AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus per employee it controls other than its CEO, 1 per Dark card on its board, and 1 per Dark card in its discard pile.

In 2022 US regulators fined sixteen banks and brokers more than \$1.8 billion for business discussed on personal phones. No wrongdoing was found in the messages; the messages were the wrongdoing.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 313 / 386

Volmageddon

MARKET - AS-IF REPLAY, 2018



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Volatility exposure. After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Inverse VIX Note it controls.

On February 5, 2018, a volatility spike caused inverse-volatility notes to collapse.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 319 / 386

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality

ACT OF GOD

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Talk about a viral tweet!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 248 / 386

Quantitative Easing

RATES - AS-IF REPLAY, 2008



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Low Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Low Interest Rates exposure.

In November 2008, the Federal Reserve began buying hundreds of billions of dollars of bonds to push long-term interest rates down. It was very clear about its plans, which was the problem.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 257 / 386

Opioid Epidemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality

▲ Litigation

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure, 4 per Litigation exposure, and 4 per Health Price exposure.

Brought to you by Purdue Pharma.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 250 / 386

Volcker Shock

RATES - AS-IF REPLAY, 1979



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▲ Liquidity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Rising Interest Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

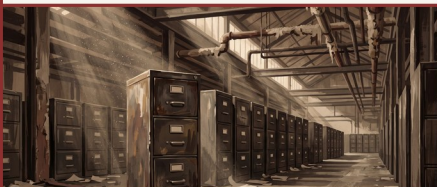
In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 308 / 386

Asbestos Claims

LITIGATION



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

DEVELOPING EVENT

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped; Developing Event: all stages this round, each with a response window.

Stage 1. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 2. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 3. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

The exposure was decades old, and the claims kept coming for decades more.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 298 / 386

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET - AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 293 / 386

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY - AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality

ACT OF GOD

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 240 / 386

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.

On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 291 / 386

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.

On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 346 / 386

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.

In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 263 / 386

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.

In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 312 / 386